Zachary Powell

Head of Developer Relations | Principal Developer Advocate

Suffolk, England, United Kingdom · Citizenship: Dual UK / US Citizen · Work Preference: Remote-First (Open to relocation UK / US / EU)

devwithzachary.com · YouTube · GitHub · LinkedIn

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Developer Relations leader, speaker, and software engineer with 15+ years working across the Android and Linux ecosystems. Experienced in building international developer communities, managing multi-disciplinary SDK and tooling teams, and driving technical content across video, open source, and conferences. Background includes a decade of leading distributed teams across North America, EMEA, and APAC—effective both setting high-level DevRel strategy and digging directly into SDK code and documentation as an advocate.

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Developer Relations & Leadership:** Developer Experience (DevEx) Strategy, Distributed Team Management, Community Building, Programme Committee Direction, Technical Speaking, Video Production & Streaming, Open Source Advocacy.
- **Mobile & Software Engineering:** Android Development (Java, Kotlin, Android SDK), Custom Android OS / AOSP, Cross-Platform & Mobile Tooling (iOS, JavaScript, Cordova), Python, PHP, Web Development.
- **Systems, Cloud & Infrastructure:** Linux Kernel & Distributions, Hardware Restoration, Embedded Systems, AWS, VoIP Systems, Network Administration.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mobile Seasons (droidcon, Fluttercon, next.app devCon)

Head of Developer Community – US/EMEA | *June 2025 – Present* | *Remote (Collaborating with Berlin HQ)*

- Direct developer community strategy, speaker relations, and programming across the US and EMEA for droidcon, Fluttercon, and next.app devCon.
- Rebuilt the conference video recording and publishing workflow, moving distribution to YouTube and growing channel subscribers from 2,000 to 6,000.
- Formed and led the programme committee for the SwiftCon track at next.app devCon, selecting speakers and shaping the technical agenda.
- Partnered with regional mobile meetups and developer communities across Europe and North America to drive conference awareness and ticket sales.
- Produced and hosted community podcasts alongside live on-site speaker interviews during flagship events.

Vonage

Manager, Developer Relations | *September 2022 – May 2025* | *Remote*

- Promoted to lead the Client SDK team after serving as Senior Android Developer Advocate.
- Managed 2 direct reports; stepped in as Acting Manager for the wider Tooling organisation during an internal transition, coordinating a distributed team of 10 engineers across multiple time zones.
- Owned product direction and DevEx for Android, iOS, and JavaScript Client SDKs, partnering with product and engineering leads to prioritize roadmap features.

Senior Android Developer Advocate | *March 2022 – September 2022* | *Remote*

- Served as "user 0" embedded within the tooling team, testing early builds of the Vonage Android SDK to catch usability issues and provide feedback prior to public release.
- Created sample applications, video guides, and technical tutorials, and spoke at conferences to drive adoption of Vonage developer tools.

Huawei Technologies Research & Development (UK) Ltd

Lead Developer Advocate | *April 2021 – March 2022* | *Greater London, United Kingdom*

- Promoted within two months to launch the Developer Advocacy function for AppGallery Connect, collaborating with engineering and product teams across China and Europe.
- Established the technical advocacy brand under "devwithzachary" across YouTube, Twitch, dev.to, and Twitter, focusing on hands-on developer education.
- Created recurring technical series including *Acronym of the Day*, *Building Serverless Android Applications*, and *Service of the Week* across video, livestreams, and written guides.
- Spoke at international conferences (DevFest, droidcon, DevRelCon, HDC) and joined industry podcasts (*Incredible Avocados*, *Developing Communities*, *DevJourney*) to share mobile development insights.

Developer Advocate | *March 2021 – April 2021* | *Greater London, United Kingdom*

- Audited documentation across AppGallery Connect services to identify usability gaps, broken samples, and onboarding friction.
- Built reference sample applications in Kotlin and Java demonstrating AppGallery Connect integrations for third-party developers.

Realtime Despatch Software Ltd

Software Engineer | *October 2018 – March 2021* | *Woodbridge, United Kingdom*

- Built features for the company's core Java-based Warehouse Management System (WMS) and handled Tier-2 technical support escalations.
- Helped migrate hosting infrastructure to AWS, developed a cross-platform Cordova mobile app, and built custom REST APIs connecting e-commerce platforms and shipping couriers.

Vixtel Pty Ltd

Software Engineer (Contract) | *January 2014 – January 2019* | *Remote (UK to Australia)*

- Worked as Lead Developer on a 5-year remote contract with Australian telecom engineering teams on Android and embedded Linux projects.
- Compiled and customized Android (AOSP) from source to run on dedicated VoIP desktop hardware.

EARLIER CAREER

- **Freelance Web & Android App Developer** | *ZPwebsites* (*September 2009 – June 2017*): Delivered native Android, iOS, and hybrid mobile apps alongside full-stack web projects for clients.
- **Network Administration** | *Anglian Catering Equipment Hire Ltd* (*July 2008 – September 2011*): Maintained internal networks and hardware; co-developed an online ordering system integrated with backend inventory tracking.

TECHNICAL CONTENT, SPEAKING & OPEN SOURCE

- **YouTube Technical Creator** (youtube.com/@devwithzachary): Independent Linux, hardware, and open-source channel with 12,300+ subscribers, 630+ videos, and ~150,000 monthly views. Notable projects include Linux gaming benchmarks (*Is Bazzite Ready for Nvidia Users?*, 55k views), Chromebook Linux conversions (37k views), and legacy hardware revivals (Surface RT, 30k views).
- **Conference Speaking** (github.com/devwithzachary/presentations): Keynote and track speaker at events including droidcon, DevFest, DevRelCon, and HDC; maintain an open repository of talk slides and materials.
- **LinuxOnAndroid** (github.com/devwithzachary/LinuxOnAndroid): Creator and lead developer of the open-source project bringing Linux distributions to Android devices via chroot environments.
- **LinuxOnVita** (github.com/devwithzachary/LinuxOnVita): Open-source experimentation project porting Linux to PlayStation Vita hardware.
- **MineServe** (github.com/devwithzachary/MineServe): Open-source server management and infrastructure utility.

EDUCATION

BSc, Computer Science | University of Essex (*2011 – 2014*)